



# TETTD Wrap Up

+ Brief look into *A Raisin in the Sun*.

# What Did We Learn from They Even Took the Dirt?

The Black Westside of Lansing was a thriving community.

It had:

- Homes / Businesses / Schools / Churches / Families / Friendships / Neighborhood traditions / A strong sense of community

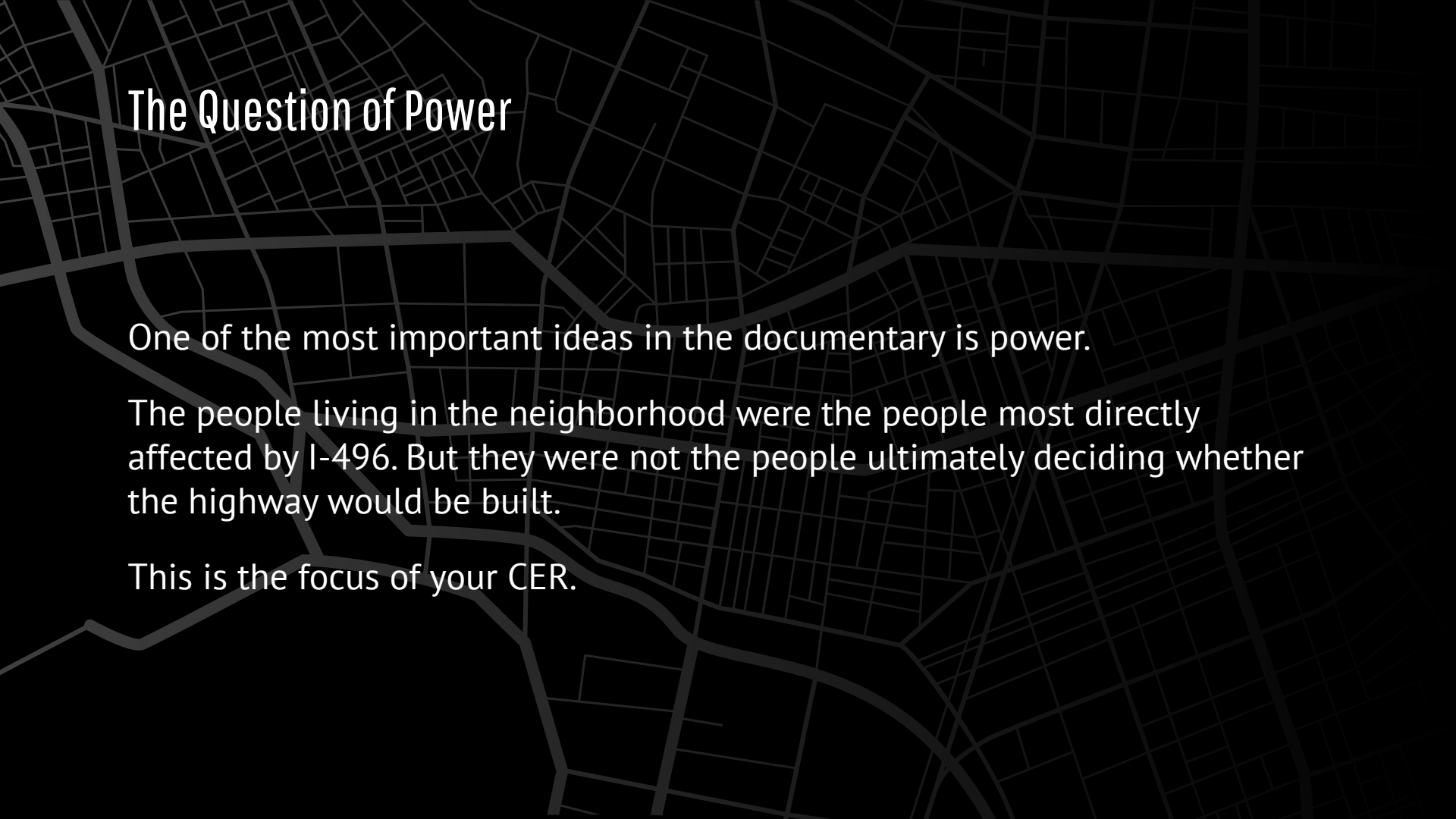
The construction of I-496 changed all of that. Hundreds of homes and numerous businesses were destroyed or displaced as the highway was built through the neighborhood.

# The Highway Wasn't Just a Highway

The destruction of the neighborhood meant more than losing buildings.

Residents lost:

- Places: homes, businesses, schools, streets
- Connections: neighbors, friends, families, community relationships
- Memories: places connected to childhood and family history
- Control: the ability to decide what would happen to their own neighborhood



# The Question of Power

One of the most important ideas in the documentary is power.

The people living in the neighborhood were the people most directly affected by I-496. But they were not the people ultimately deciding whether the highway would be built.

This is the focus of your CER.

# Why Tell These Stories Decades Later?

They Even Took the Dirt does not just tell us what happened. It shows us how people remembered what happened.

The documentary gives former residents the opportunity to tell their own stories about:

- What their neighborhood was like
- What they lost
- How they experienced the changes
- What the community meant to them

# CER Time

Take your quotes & respond to the CER boxes on the worksheet. Following the correct CER format. When finished, convert your CER into a **polished paragraph** response.

This paragraph should be 6+ sentences long. Polished means you go back & check spelling/grammar/mechanics. If you would like to type (whatever the reason, poor handwriting, line spacing is too small, proofing help, easier to see CER & type at the same time) you may. This worksheet is posted on Google Classroom, you have to type there. Make sure you turn in both the digital & physical half.

# A Polished Paragraph =

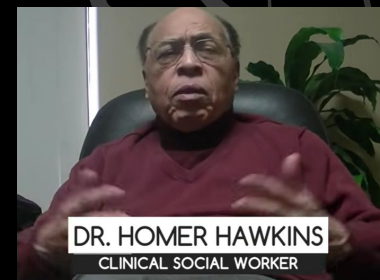
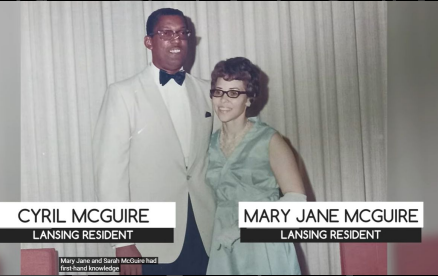
Correct spelling, grammar, capitalization, & punctuation. Reread your writing. Don't rush through it. Make sure you fully flush out your thought and don't leave any ideas hanging.

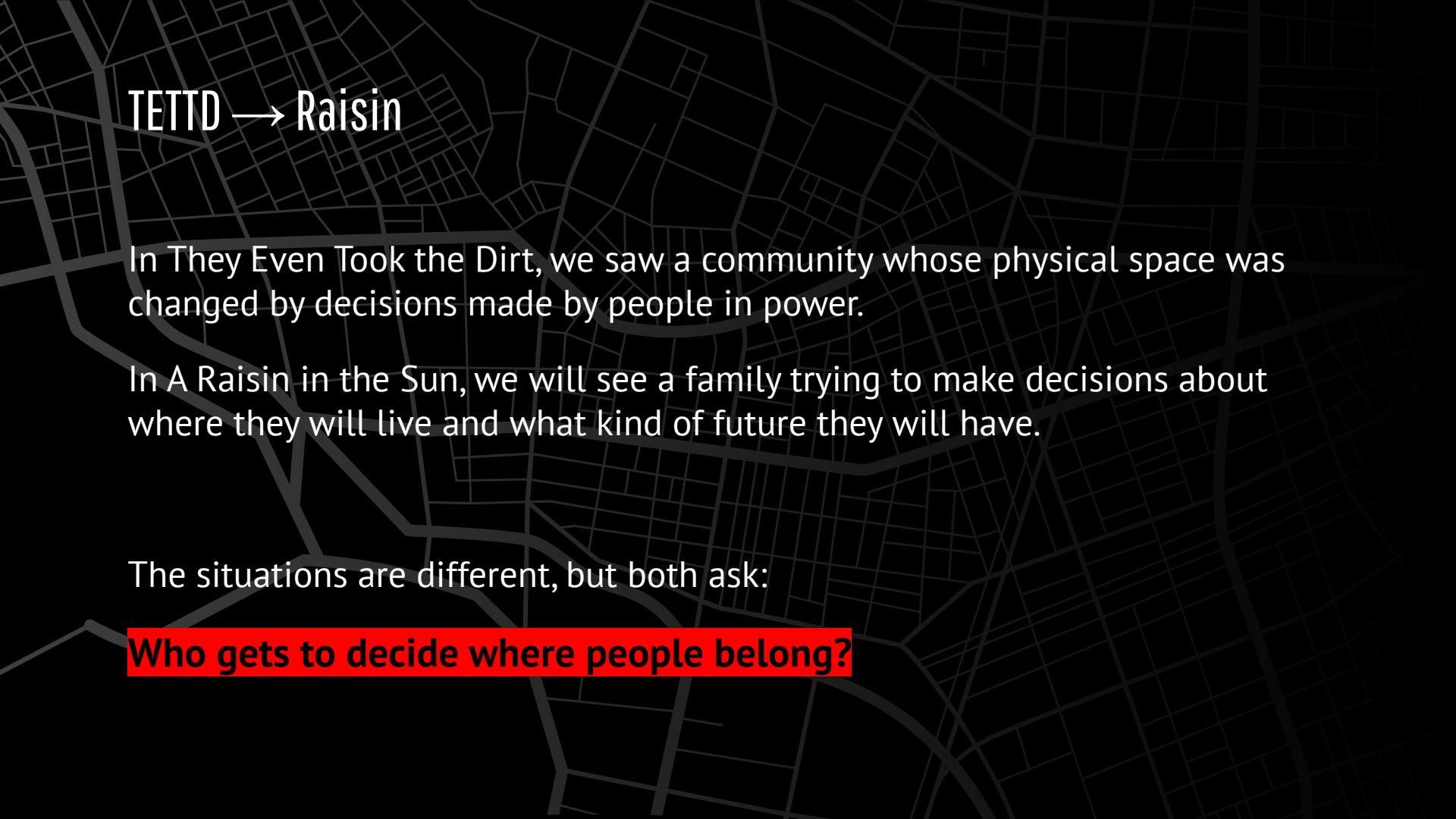
Quotes are set into the paragraph, not just dropped in. Introduce the context of your quote before you use it. E.g. "When discussing \_\_\_\_\_, one resident said, "\_\_\_\_\_."

6 sentences is the minimum, but not the suggestion. It may take you more to fully explain your answer to the guiding question.

If you don't have a speaker's name, give me context to who they are (resident/shopkeeper/Lansing local/etc)

MLA suggestion: say the speaker's name in the sentence. E.g.: james said "blah blah blah" (They Even Took the Dirt). Or (TETTD)





## TETTD → Raisin

In *They Even Took the Dirt*, we saw a community whose physical space was changed by decisions made by people in power.

In *A Raisin in the Sun*, we will see a family trying to make decisions about where they will live and what kind of future they will have.

The situations are different, but both ask:

**Who gets to decide where people belong?**

# From Community to One Family

They Even Took the Dirt focuses on an entire community. A Raisin in the Sun focuses on one family.

But both ask us to think about what happens when people's lives are shaped by forces larger than themselves, especially prejudice.

